

UNIT 1 / Your first conversations

Spell it out

Your goal: Spell names and recognise German letters and special characters.

01 Learn the idea

German uses the letters A to Z plus ä, ö, ü and ß. The names of letters differ from English: J is jot, W is weh and Z is tsett in approximate English spelling. These hints are only a starting point; use the listening buttons and practise saying a name slowly, one letter at a time.

Buchstabieren means to spell. Ask Wie schreibt man das? when you need the written form. ß is called Eszett or scharfes S; it is not the letter B. An umlaut can change meaning: schon and schön are different words. Keep the dots when copying names, and check the spelling back to the other person.

Words and phrases

German	English
Wie schreibt man das?	How do you write that?
Bitte buchstabieren Sie.	Please spell it.
Mein Name ist Müller.	My name is Müller.
Mit ü.	With ü.
Noch einmal, bitte.	Once again, please.

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Receptionist

Wie ist Ihr Name?

What is your name?

Guest

Müller. Mit ü.

Müller. With ü.

Receptionist

Bitte buchstabieren Sie.

Please spell it.

Your real-life mission

Spell your first name and surname aloud. Then write Müller, Straße and schön, marking the letters that are not in the English alphabet.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Wie schreibt man das?” mean?

- A. Please spell it.
- B. My name is Müller.
- C. How do you write that?

2. What does “Bitte buchstabieren Sie.” mean?

- A. Please spell it.
- B. My name is Müller.
- C. With ü.

3. What does “Mein Name ist Müller.” mean?

- A. With ü.
- B. My name is Müller.
- C. Once again, please.

4. Which character is called Eszett?

- A. B
- B. ü
- C. ß

5. Which special letter is in the guest's name?

- A. ä
- B. ü
- C. ö

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. C - How do you write that?

“Wie schreibt man das?” means “How do you write that?”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. A - Please spell it.

“Bitte buchstabieren Sie.” means “Please spell it.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. B - My name is Müller.

“Mein Name ist Müller.” means “My name is Müller.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. C - ß

ß is Eszett; it represents an s sound and is not a capital B.

5. B - ü

The guest explicitly says Mit ü.

One possible mission response

Müller: M - ü - l - l - e - r. Straße contains ß. Schön contains ö.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

Open your interactive course at <https://everygyan.com/learn-german>. Free additional A1 practice: <https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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